

stand the gameplay and place these objects at specific locations in the map. During this placement, the designers make sure that the rooms, corridors, buildings etc are easy to navigate when a player plays the level.

Placing actors

In each game level, there are objects that behave as action helper objects or triggers. An actor is anything that has some code attached to it and is used to trigger some event. These objects tell when and where different action sequences, sounds, weapons, healing kits, visual effects etc should appear in the level. They are not seen when the game runs but their visual/audible effects are seen by the player.

For example, an actor called “Player Start” is used to indicate where the player will be once the level begins. The popular level editors come with easy interfaces to easily add actors and assets attached to them.

Placing non-static objects

Here, we specifying non-static parts of a level, such as doors, keys and buttons with associated mechanisms, teleporters, hidden passageways; which the player can interact with.

Placing entities

Now, locations of various entities, such as player units, enemies, monster spawn points, ladders, coins, resource nodes, weapons, save points etc are specified.

Lighting a level

Game level lighting is an important part for level design. Designers convey feelings of surprise, joy, fear, panic etc through lighting. Popular editors like UnrealEd and Unity have specialized lighting engine that allow level designers to render variety of lights in the level environment. Different kinds of light sources can be used and their properties/location can be tweaked to achieve desired results. Lights can be static, dynamic, Omni directional or directed. Light sources can be anything: small or large lamps hanging on walls or from ceilings, the moon or the sun, crystals, lasers and other type of high tech beams, fire, mirrors, magical effects, water surfaces that bounce back light, lava or radioactive slime and so on. Everything is possible as long as there is a noticeable source. Level designers thus have to be careful in lighting game levels.